

Saudi Arabia POS Payments — 2020-2025

SAMA POS Transaction Data · May 2020 - Jul 2025

year
All

city
All

Sectors →

Cities →

Spending →

Growth →

Insights →

Total Transaction Value

\$664.4

Prior Year Value

\$623.9

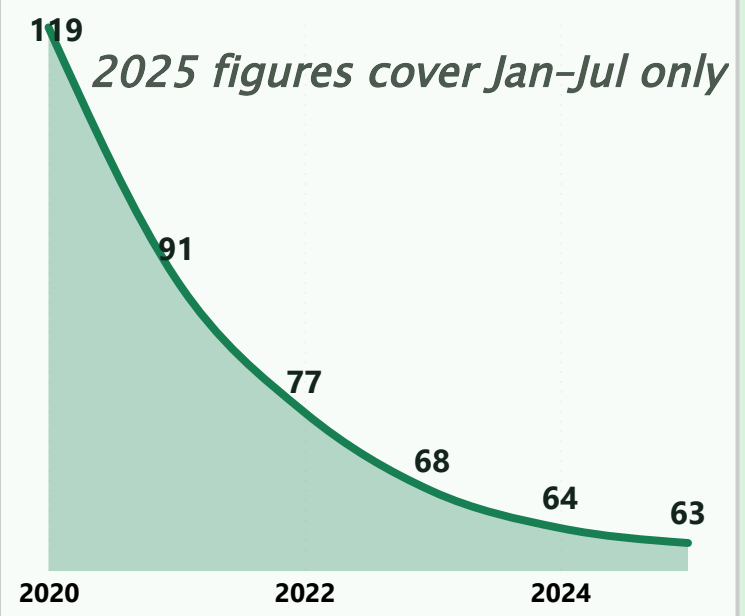
Year-over-Year Growth

▲ +6.50%

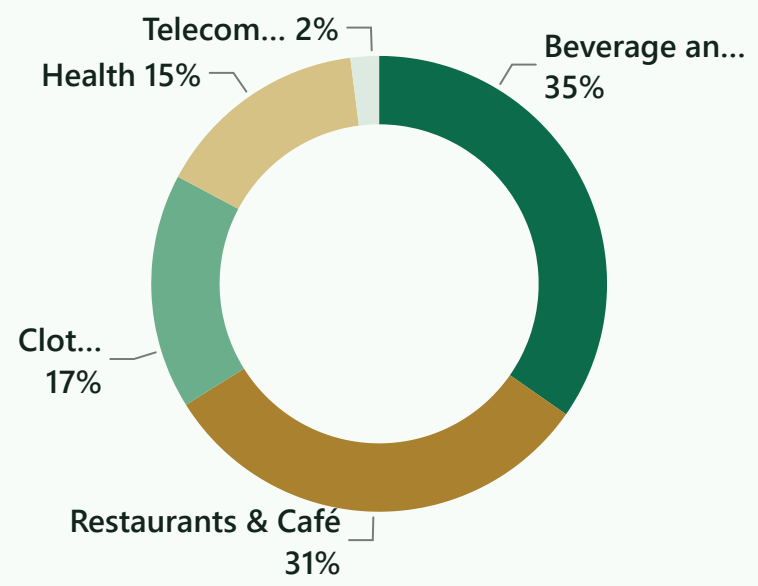
Average Transaction Size

73.84

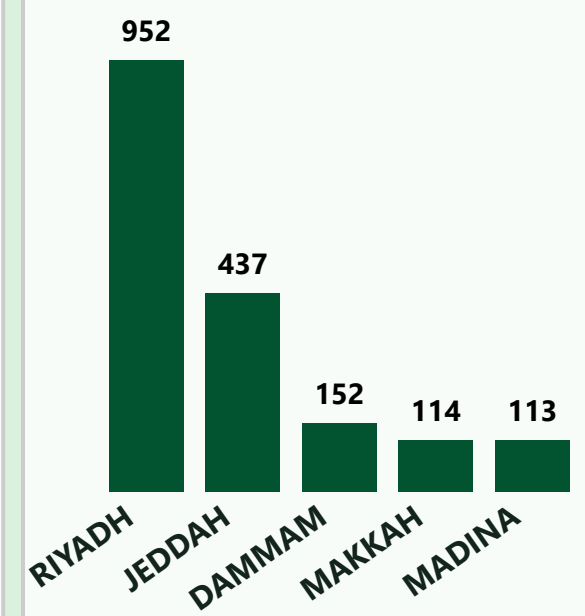
Basket Size Over Time



Top Sectors by Spending



Top Cities by Spending (SAR bn)

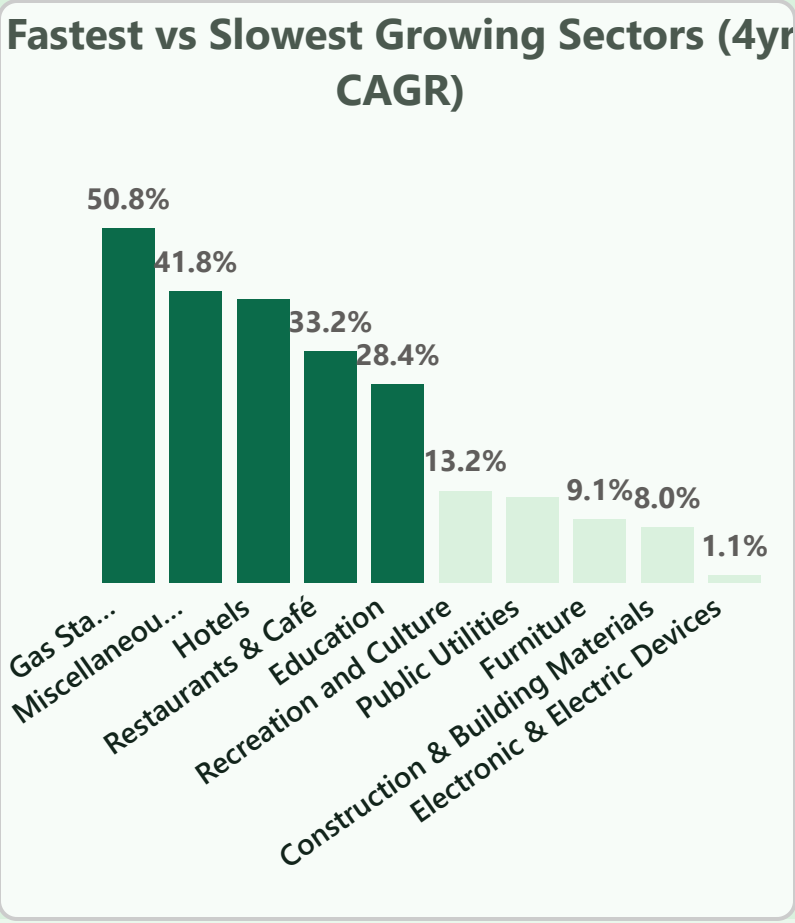
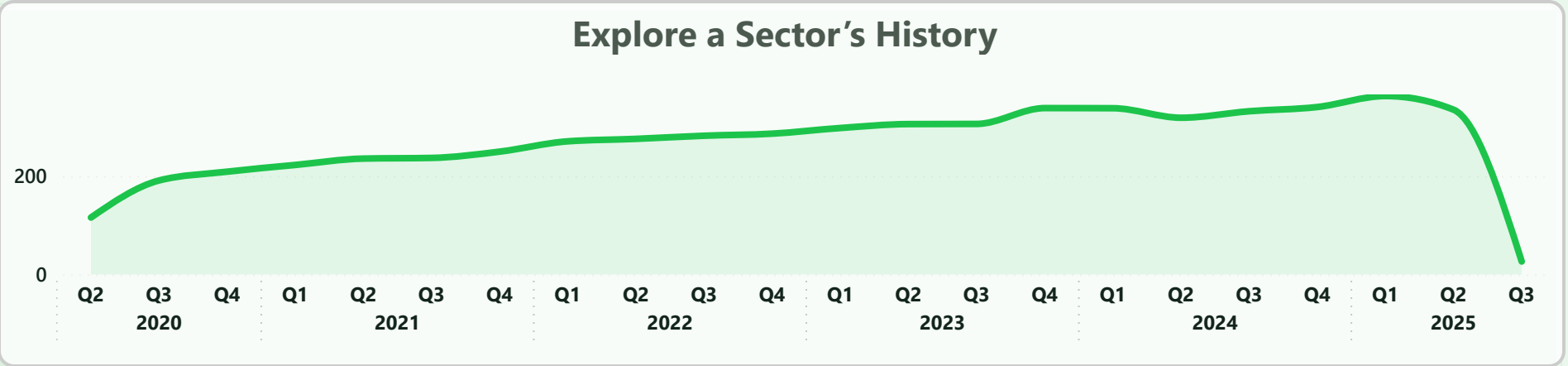


sector

All

Cities

→



All Sectors Ranked by 2024 Value

Beverage and Food	451
Restaurants & Café	408
Miscellaneous Goods and Services	316
Clothing and Footwear	217
Health	198
Gas Stations	181
Transportation	164
Construction & Building Materials	95
Furniture	85
Recreation and Culture	75
Jewelry	68
Electronic & Electric Devices	67
Hotels	64
Education	42
Telecommunications	26
Public Utilities	22

sector	Value by Sector (bn)	Sector Share %	Sector CAGR %
Transportation	164.11	2.8%	26.6%
Telecommunication	26.32	0.4%	27.3%
Restaurants & Café	408.16	6.9%	33.2%
Recreation and Culture	74.82	1.3%	13.2%
Public Utilities	21.77	0.4%	12.2%
Miscellaneous Goods and Services	316.48	5.4%	41.8%
Jewelry	67.96	1.2%	13.4%
Hotels	64.06	1.1%	40.7%
Health	197.51	3.4%	17.7%
Gas Stations	181.18	3.1%	50.8%
Furniture	84.53	1.4%	9.1%
Electronic & Electric Devices	67.03	1.1%	1.1%
Education	42.30	0.7%	28.4%
Construction & Building Materials	95.03	1.6%	8.0%
Clothing and Footwear	217.06	2.7%	21.4%

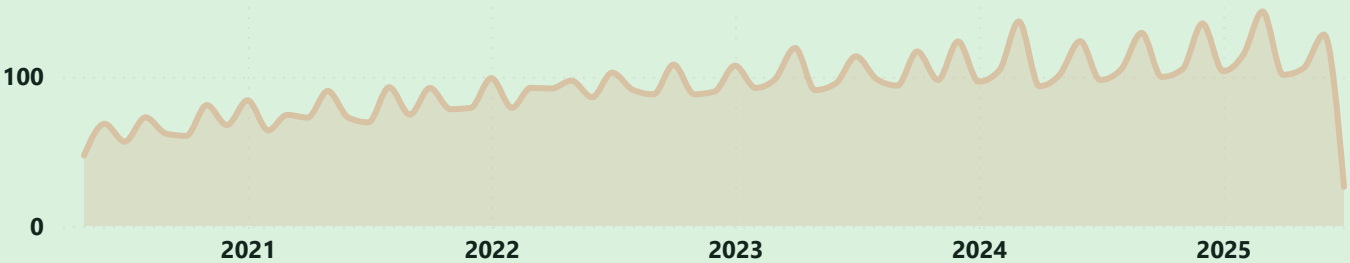
city

All

Spending Behavior



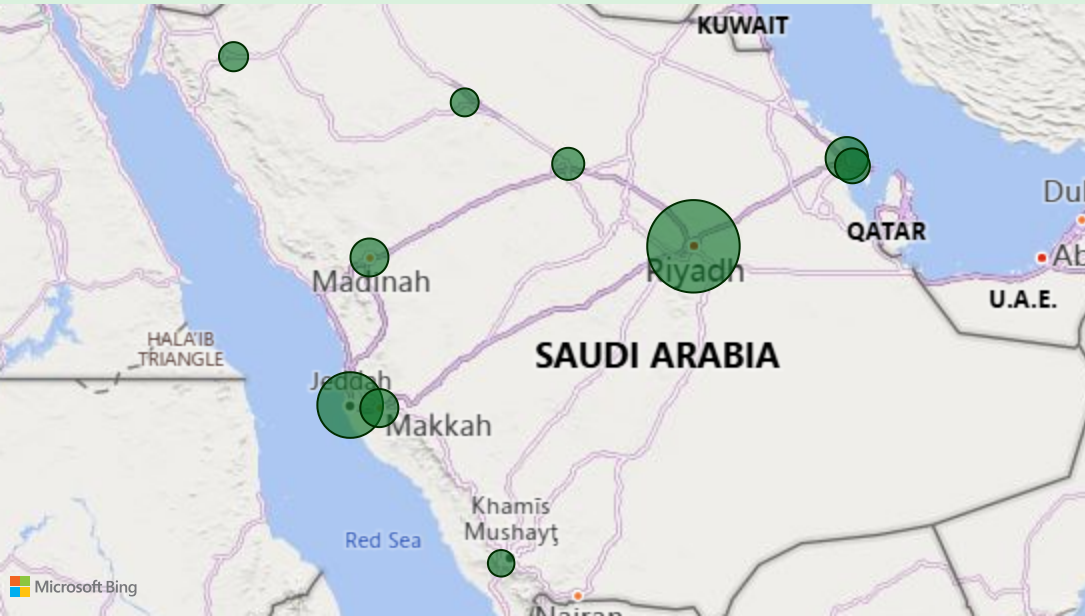
Explore a City's History



Full City Breakdown

city	Value by City (bn)	City Share %	City CAGR %
RIYADH	951.99	16.2%	28.9%
JEDDAH	437.42	7.4%	22.7%
DAMMAM	151.89	2.6%	22.2%
MAKKAH	114.02	1.9%	40.0%
MADINA	113.49	1.9%	29.3%
KHOBAR	90.14	1.5%	18.2%
BURAIDAH	71.70	1.2%	22.1%
TABOUK	54.41	0.9%	28.5%

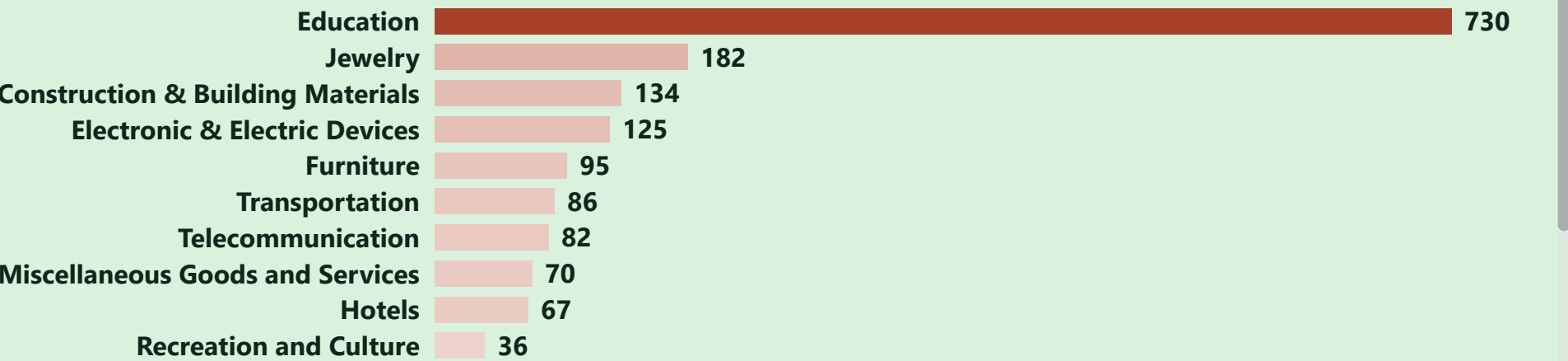
Where the Spending Happens



City Growth Rates (4yr CAGR)

MAKKAH	RIYADH	JEDDAH	DAM...	BURAI...
	28.9%			
	TABOUK			
40.0%		22.7%	22.2%	22.1%
MADINA	28.5%	ABHA	KHOBAR	
	HAIL			
29.3%	24.8%	20.7%		18.2%

Most vs Least Volatile Sectors (SAR)



Lowest Ticket Sector

Restaurants & Café — SAR 33

Highest Ticket Sector

Education — SAR 1,369

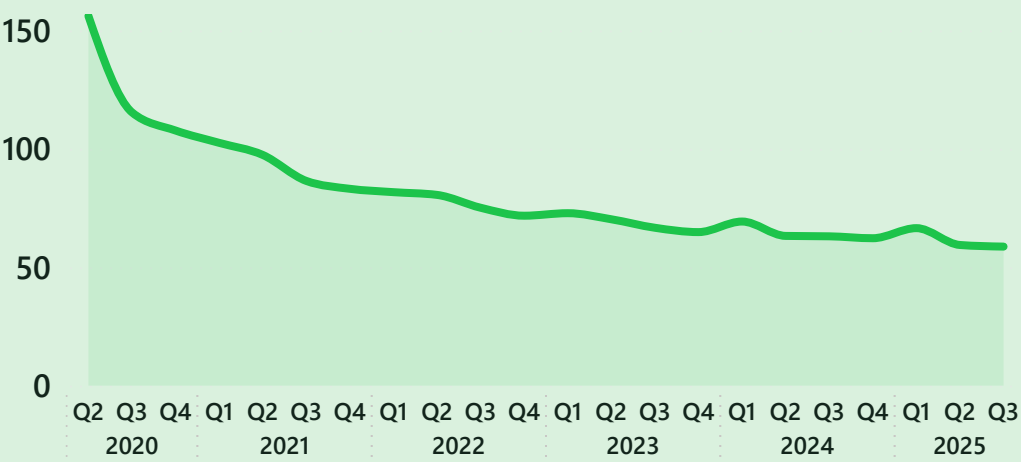
AVG Ticket Size 2020 → 2025

148 → 59

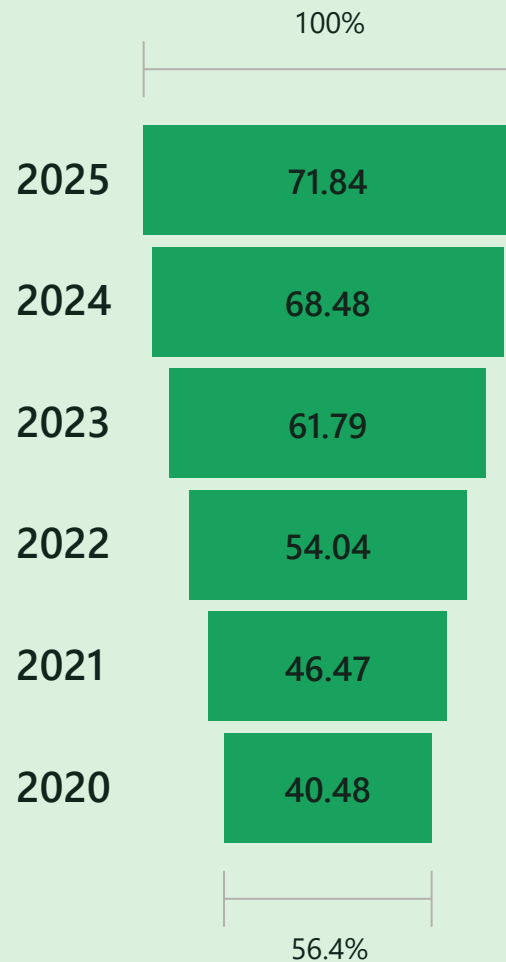
Average Ticket Size by Sector



Basket Size Over Time



Peak Spending Intensity by Year

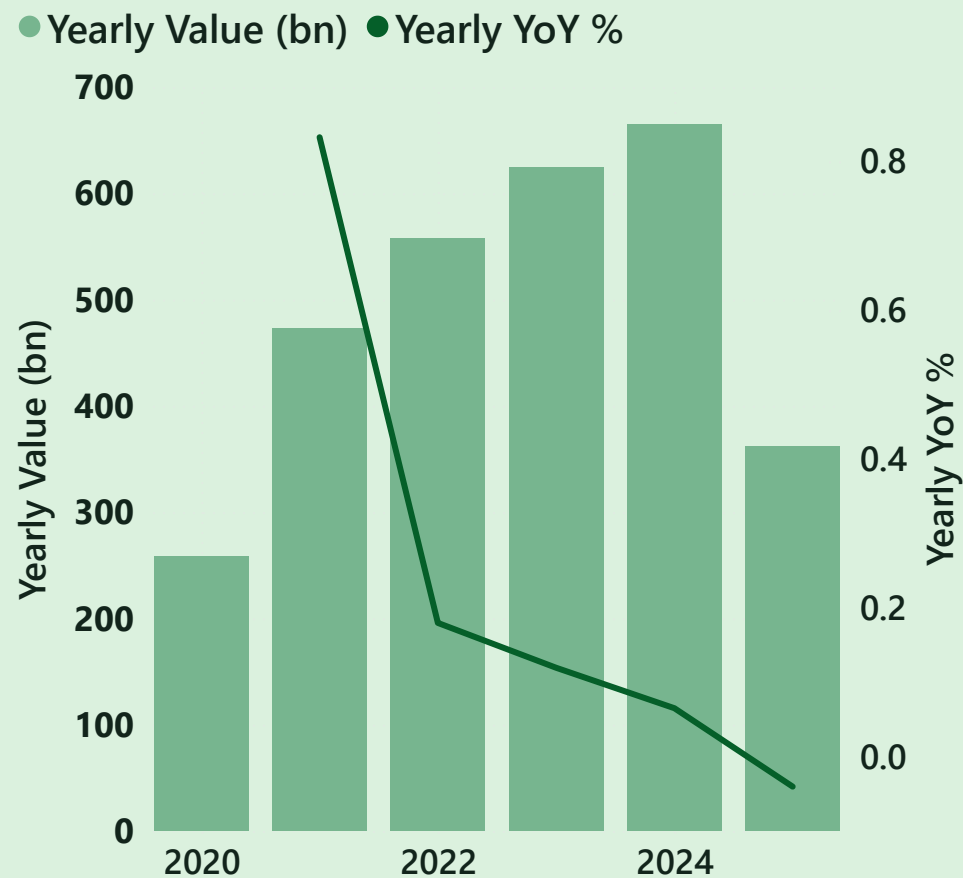


Strongest Seasonal Month December
(+7% above average)

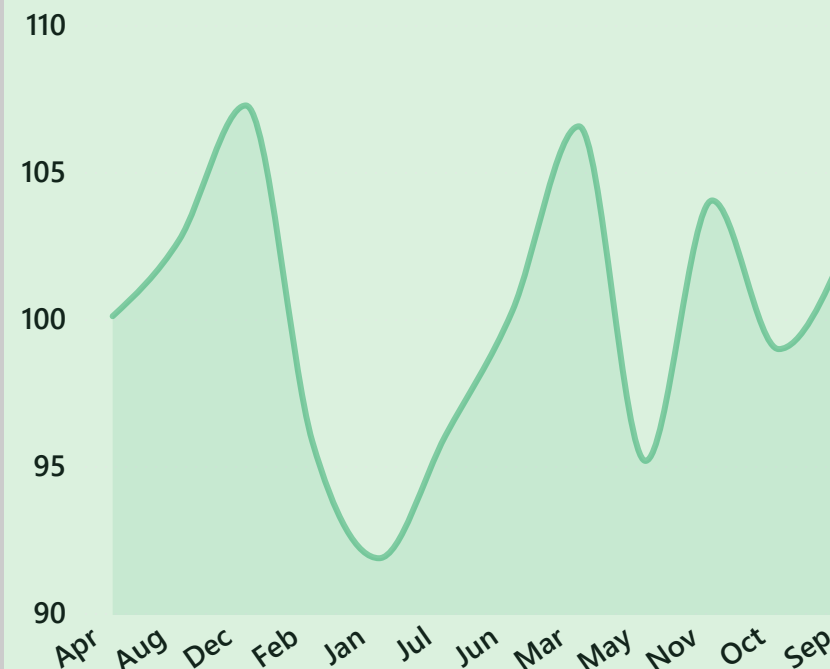
Transaction Growth 2020-2024
4.8x (2.17bn → 10.32bn)

Value Growth 2020-2024
2.6x (SAR 257.8bn → 664.4bn)

Annual Value & Year-over-Year Growth



Monthly Seasonality Pattern



100 = year-round average month



4.8x

Transaction volume grew nearly twice as fast as transaction value since 2020 — proof that card payments have shifted from occasional to habitual

60.5%

The average basket size fell from SAR 149 to SAR 59, as cards displaced cash for small, everyday purchases rather than only big-ticket spend

33.7%

Riyadh alone generates a third of all national card spending — more than Jeddah, Dammam and Makkah combined

+50.8%

Gas Stations is the fastest-compounding sector since 2020 (CAGR), followed by Miscellaneous Goods & Services and Hotels.

+40.0%*

Makkah is the fastest-growing major city by CAGR, ahead of Madina and Riyadh — likely tracking religious tourism recovery

March

Peak spending has shifted to March in both 2024 and 2025, aligning with Ramadan — a break from the year-end peaks seen in 2022–2023

Reading the Data

1. Cash-to-card conversion, not just economic growth, is driving the numbers. Transactions grew 4.8x while value grew 2.6x between 2020 and 2024 — spending itself didn't quadruple, but the share of it happening on cards did.
2. Everyday categories are absorbing the growth. Restaurants & Café and Beverage and Food carry the lowest average ticket sizes (SAR 33–41) and rank among the largest sectors by value — a sign that habitual, low-value card use is now mainstream.
3. Geography is concentrated but shifting. Riyadh and Jeddah together hold nearly half of national spend, yet Makkah, Madina and Tabouk are compounding faster — pointing to tourism and secondary-city growth outpacing the capital.
4. Ramadan is now a visible national demand shock. 2024 and 2025 both peaked in March; prior years peaked at year-end, suggesting the lunar calendar's alignment with early-year months is reshaping national retail seasonality.
5. Volatility varies sharply by category. Education swings the most month to month (small base, academic-calendar driven), while Gas Stations and Restaurants are the most stable — useful context for anyone forecasting sector-level demand.
6. 2025 figures are partial-year (through July) and should not be compared directly to full-year 2020–2024 totals without annualizing.

Overview



Sectors



Cities



Spending



Growth

